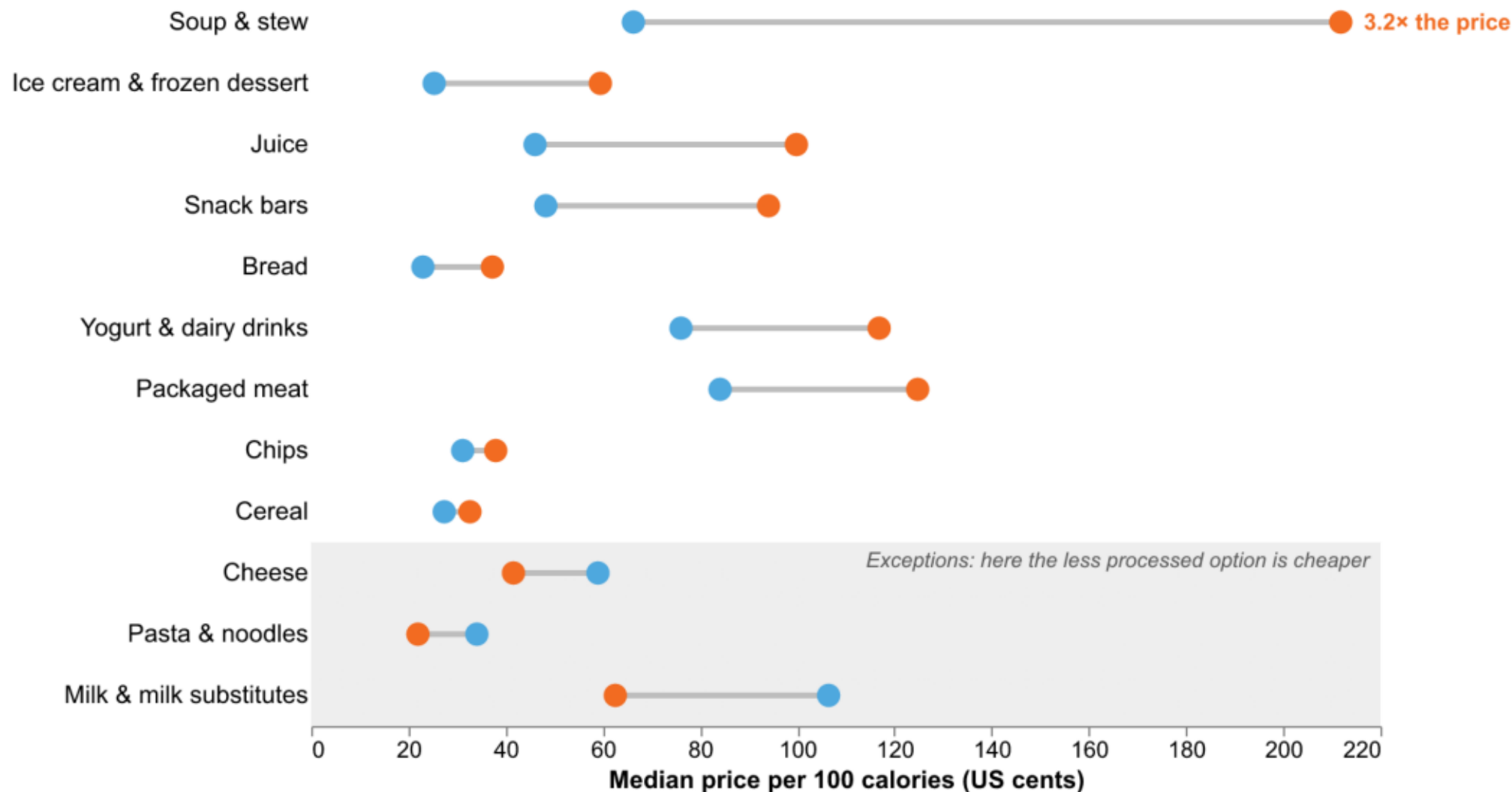


Plot A

## Less processed food usually costs more per calorie

Items in each aisle are split into thirds by Food Processing Score; each dot is the median price of one third. 12 familiar aisles shown. Across all 47 aisles with 60+ priced items, the less processed third costs more in 37.

● Least processed third ● Most processed third



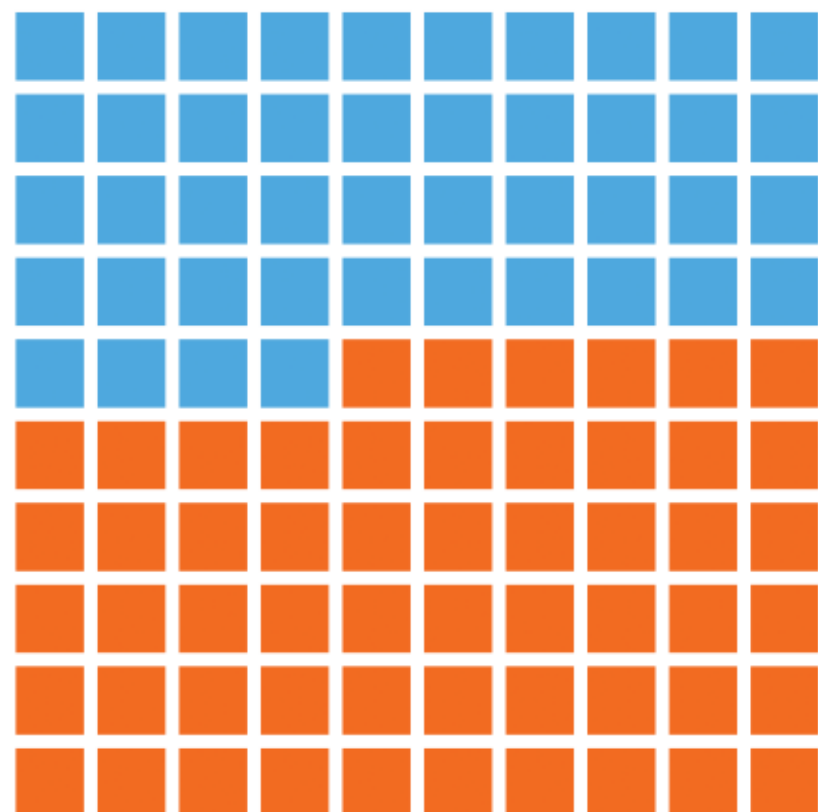
Plot B

## More than half of “organic” groceries are still ultra-processed

Each square is 1% of a group's products. Organic = the product name contains “organic” or “organics”.

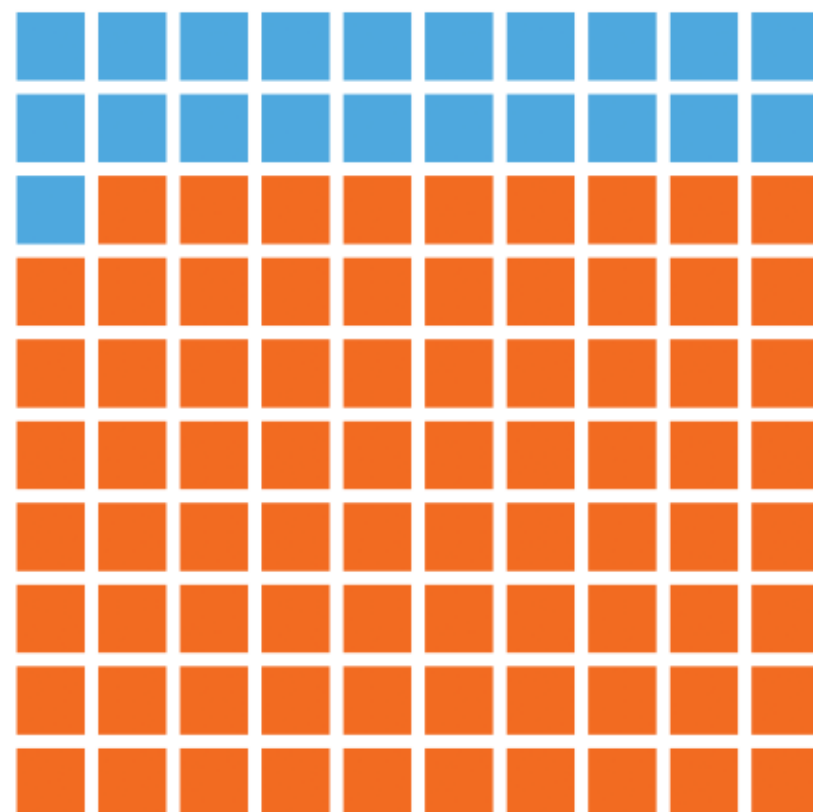
### 56% ultra-processed

Name says organic (3,359 products)



### 79% ultra-processed

Everything else (22,891 products)

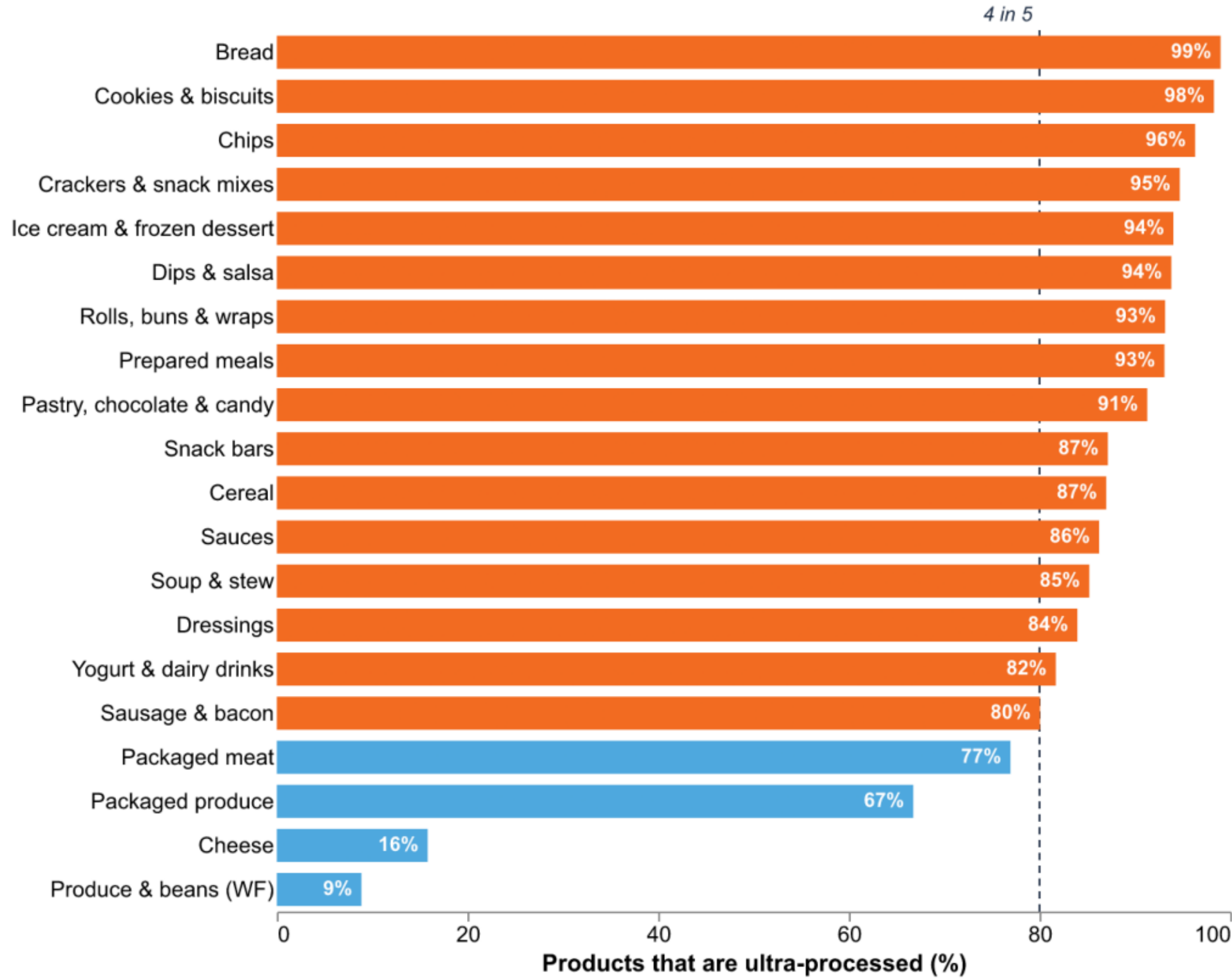


■ Ultra-processed (NOVA class 3)   ■ Not ultra-processed (classes 0-2)

Plot C

# In 16 of the 20 biggest aisles, at least 4 in 5 products are ultra-processed

The 20 aisles with the most products (19,046 products). Ultra-processed = predicted NOVA class 3.  
Orange bars: 80% or more. Only cheese and fresh produce are mostly not ultra-processed.



## Preferred plot

I prefer Plot A, the price comparison inside each aisle. It's the only one of the three that ties processing to something a shopper feels at the register, and comparing items within the same aisle means the gap comes from processing, not from comparing bread to steak. For each aisle I split the priced items into thirds by Food Processing Score and plot the median price per 100 calories of the least and the most processed third. Both dots sit on one shared price axis, so the length of the gray line between them is the price gap, and position is the most accurate channel for that comparison. Orange is always the less processed third, and the same orange is the accent in the other two plots. I show 12 familiar aisles so the chart stays readable, and the subtitle gives the full count (the less processed third costs more in 37 of 47 aisles) so the selection doesn't hide anything. The three exceptions (cheese, pasta and milk) are shaded and labeled rather than left out. Plot B is the simplest to read, with each square standing for 1% of products, but its point (56% of "organic" products are still ultra-processed) is a single share and leaves out price entirely. Plot C, a sorted bar chart, shows that 16 of the 20 biggest aisles are at least 80% ultra-processed, which is striking but describes the shelves more than it argues anything. Plot A's weakness is that price per calorie favors calorie-dense food, and a median hides the spread inside each third. In the final version I'll check whether price per gram tells the same story.